



6 280100 002394

FRIDAY
OCTOBER 2, 2026
RABI AL THANI 21, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

GULF NEWS

gulfnews.com



LIVE
UPDATES



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ Vijay Vaghela, CEO of *Gulf News*; Mark Thompson, Editor-in-Chief, *Gulf News*; Abdulla Rashid, Abu Dhabi Editor; Tariq Zekra, General Manager, Hero Real Estate; Charlie Booth, Head of Corporate Communications, Masdar; Mina Kiwan, Senior Director, Media Relations, MEMAC Ogilvy, and others at the opening of the new *Gulf News* office in Abu Dhabi.

GULF NEWS' ABU DHABI OFFICE OPENS DOORS

The event marked a proud new chapter for one of the UAE's most trusted newspapers | P11

ABU DHABI

Meet the man behind Abu Dhabi's Posters for 50 years | P1



ABU DHABI

Emirate completes 60 projects worth Dh12b, unveils next phase | P111

World's tallest gold bar on display in Sharjah

2.12-metre gold bar is styled as a ruler

DUBAI

BY STACY PEREIRA
Business Reporter

The world's tallest gold bar is on display at the 58th Watch & Jewellery Middle East Show at Expo Centre Sharjah, where visitors can stand next to it and compare their height.

The bar, presented by the Bullion Trading C, measures 2.12 metres, or 6 feet 11.5 inches. It carries an official Guinness World Records title, backed by a certificate issued by Guinness World Records.

Golden ruler

BTC has styled the piece as a golden ruler, and the display is built around the theme "Measure Your Height in Gold".

Visitors can stand beside the bar to see how they measure up against it, and photos are part of the experience.

The bar is mounted vertically on a dedicated platform with the exhibition's branding. The Guinness World Records certificate

is displayed next to it and officially names the bar as the record holder.

The display offers a different way to present gold, combining the precious metal with design and showing it on a scale most visitors will not have seen before.

500 brands

BTC's participation is part of the Watch & Jewellery Middle East Show, which runs at Expo Centre Sharjah until October 4. The exhibition brings together more than 500 brands from 19 countries across more than 30,000 square metres.

It also includes five international pavilions, from Hong Kong, India, Italy, Singapore and Thailand.

The show has run for more than five decades and attracts jewellery houses, brands, designers, buyers and industry professionals. Exhibitors present new designs and collections in gold, diamonds, precious gemstones and watches.

TELL ME WHY

Connectivity and customisation are reshaping mobility, says Ankush Arora, Mansour Automotive's Group CEO



Scan the QR code to watch the podcast

NATION

How Etihad Rail looked 10 years ahead and chose Al Yalayis | P2



SPECIAL REPORTS

Feel the Gen Z pulse in launch edition of OH! Yeah magazine plus Celebrate Germany Unity Day

Dubai schools can shift timings to ease traffic

Prior approval, student well-being, parental support are the conditions

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Schools will be allowed to change their timings to ease traffic congestion and make the daily commute easier for students and teachers, but only with prior approval from the Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA).

Aisha Miran, KHDA Director General, clarified the authority's position at a Media Majlis yesterday, responding to a *Gulf News* question as some schools have begun staggering start times.

Well-being first

Any change must put student well-being first and take parents' feedback into account. "When you want to change

MORE TO COME

KHDA is drafting a policy and standards on artificial intelligence (AI) and device use covering every school and educational institution in Dubai.

Meanwhile, the authority also revealed that Dubai will add about 18,000 affordable private schools.

school timings, you must take student well-being into account," she said.

The official also highlighted the need for the parent community's support.

Miran recalled a case where a school altered timings and parents complained. KHDA stepped in, and the school had to meet requirements and revise their timetables.

Walk, cycle, use scooter

On the commute itself, she said the Dubai Education Masterplan should help. "We would love to see our kids going to school walking, cycling or on a safe scooter, rather than on electric scooters," she said.

Families who prefer private cars or school buses will still have acceptable options.

SEE ALSO P4

UAE probes flydubai cockpit incident

INVESTIGATION TO EXAMINE CIRCUMSTANCES AND MOTIVES

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

UAE judicial authorities have launched an investigation into an incident aboard a flydubai flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv that was diverted to Saudi Arabia and landed safely, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs said yesterday.

Flight FZ1073 from Dubai International Airport to Tel Aviv landed safely at Tabuk Airport following an incident in the flight deck, the ministry said.

UAE Attorney General Counselor Dr Hamad Al Shamsi ordered a team of specialised Public Prosecution members to investigate the circumstances and causes of the incident.

The investigation will examine all circumstances and motives, including any possible connection to terrorist activity or intent and whether the incident involved prior planning or direction, the ministry said.

The incident

The move follows flydubai's confirmation that an altercation occurred in the flight deck, prompting crew members travelling on board to intervene and secure the aircraft.

The UAE said its judicial authorities had jurisdiction because the aircraft is registered in the UAE and bears the country's flag. UAE law therefore applies to crimes committed on board the aircraft even outside UAE territory, it said.

The ministry thanked Saudi authorities for their cooperation and handling of the incident, and urged the public to



AFP

■ Smit Machchhar

The UAE said its judicial authorities had jurisdiction because the aircraft is registered in the UAE and bears the country's flag. UAE law therefore applies to crimes committed on board the aircraft even outside UAE territory, it said.

rely on official statements and avoid speculation or unverified information while the investigation continues.

Additionally, the UAE Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan also discussed the incident during a telephone call with Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Sa'ar, including the safety of passengers aboard FZ1073.

The two ministers also discussed bilateral relations and wider regional developments.

Flights suspended

Following the incident on Wednesday, flydubai said its flights to and from Israel would be suspended while the investigation continues.

"The safety and wellbeing of our passengers, crew and operations remain our highest priority," the airline said, adding that the suspension would allow authorities to establish the facts surrounding the incident.

Emirates also said its code-share operations with flydubai to and from Tel Aviv were suspended with immediate effect until further notice.

Passengers whose final destination is Tel Aviv will not be accepted for travel at their point of origin, Emirates said. Customers already travelling to Tel Aviv will be supported in completing their journeys.

Pilot recovering

Captain Smit Machchhar, who was injured during the incident, has been airlifted to the UAE from Saudi Arabia, where he had been receiving treatment, the Indian Embassy in Abu Dhabi said. Indian Ambassador to the UAE Dr Deepak Mittal visited Machchhar and his family at a hospital yesterday, the embassy said.

"Captain Machchhar is in good health and recovering well," the embassy said, adding that it remained in close coordination with local authorities over his medical care and wellbeing.

Machchhar had earlier undergone surgery at a hospital in Tabuk and was reported to be in stable condition.

FOR UPDATES AND LATEST NEWS, LOG ONTO GULFNEWS.COM

IN FOCUS

Check out the 9 important events and updates in UAE this month | P6-7

Subscribe In print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel: 600 587 234
E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00